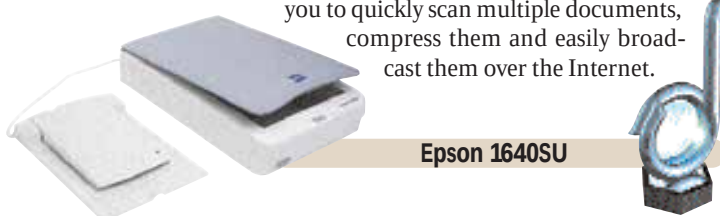


SCANNERS

Scanners have come a long way since those clunky handheld monochrome models that first graced our work spaces. Today, full-colour, high-resolution scans are easily accessible for home users. Colour depths in excess of 24 bits are used in order to reproduce the accuracy of the scan and thanks to the shift from a parallel port interface to USB, scanning speeds have witnessed a boost.

The future of scanners looks bright with the advances in technology and useability. Further improvements in bit-depths and resolutions are on the horizon. In addition, look out for faster interface standards such as FireWire. For those with particularised needs, look-out for scanning solutions which feature a typical scanner bundled with special hardware and software to maximise scanning abilities in a particular field. As an example, a Web publishing scanning solution can include a flatbed scanner, a multipage feeder and compression software that allows you to quickly scan multiple documents, compress them and easily broadcast them over the Internet.



Epson 1640SU

Combines a stunning colour reproduction with a great speed

This is an excellent printer for office use and for desktop publishing because of its lightning speed and impressive image quality, whether it is a colour image or a mono text. It is a snap to use with its bundled software. The moment you put a target for scanning, the TWAIN driver automatically identifies it to be either a document or an image, and scans it at the appropriate resolution and colour depth. This feature is especially beneficial for new users who may not understand the intricacies of resolution and colour depth.

+ Very fast preview time
+ Excellent image reproduction
Price: Rs 22,500
Contact: Epson India Ltd

Phone: 080-5321266-70
Fax: 080-5581799
E-mail: sheetal@eid.epson.co.in
Reviewed in: June 2001

Worthy Mentions

HP Scanjet 5300

+ Excellent build quality
+ Good bundling of supporting applications
Price: Not available
Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd
Phone: 011-6826000
Fax: 011-6826030
E-mail: princy_bhatnagar@hp.com
Reviewed in: June 2001

Epson 1240U Photo

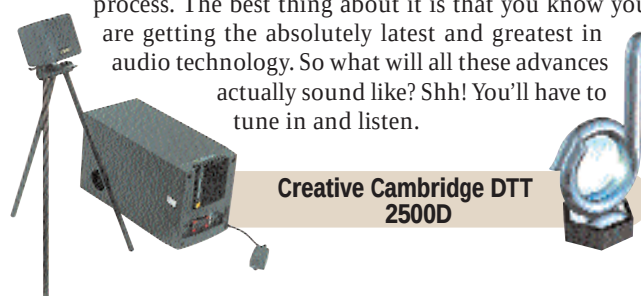
+ Good scanning resolution (1200 x 2400 optical)
+ Transparency scanning capabilities
Price: Not available
Contact: Epson India Ltd
Phone: 080-5321266-70
Fax: 080-5581799
E-mail: sheetal@eid.epson.co.in
Reviewed in: June 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Microtek ScanMaker 4 1999: AGFA DuoScan T1200 1998: AGFA SnapScan

SPEAKERS

An immersive experience is the key as the focus continues to be on digital audio. Stereo sound provides a field of sound in front, but multichannel audio provides sound from all directions, which is very close to a real-world audio experience. The importance given to audio stems from the need to immerse oneself whether it be gameplay, movie watching or just enjoying music. The focus on creating a real-world environment is witnessed today with more and more high-end speakers being available for the PC.

Audio standards demand support for more channels, and you can be sure that this will be reflected in PC audio. Adopting standards in PC hardware is a relatively easy and quick process. The best thing about it is that you know you are getting the absolutely latest and greatest in audio technology. So what will all these advances actually sound like? Shh! You'll have to tune in and listen.



Creative Cambridge DTT 2500D

Speakers that are capable of giving you sound at its crispest best—virtual reality for sound

When it comes to Dolby Digital compliance in your home, the Cambridge DTT2500D speakers have what it takes. With six discrete channels coupled with a Dolby Digital multi-channel amplifier, this system can give you a very immersive experience. With its sheer power and sound quality this surround speaker set makes a great buy for the avid gamer, music lover, or movie buff.

+ Amazing surround sound quality, S/PDIF support
+ Crystal clear satellites and distortion-free subwoofer

Price: Rs 28,000

Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd

Phone: 022-8305500

Fax: 022-8238619

E-mail: info@compuageindia.com

Reviewed in: August 2001

Worthy Mentions

Logitech xtrusio DSR100+

+ Clear choice for 3D gaming setup
+ Power-packed subwoofer
Price: Rs 12,000
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260256-59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Reviewed in: August 2001

Creative FPS1000

+ Clear satellites
+ Competitively priced
Price: Rs 4,680
Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd.
Phone: 022-8305500
Fax: 022-8238619
E-mail: info@compuageindia.com
Reviewed in: August 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Creative Desktop Theater 5.1 DTT2500 1999: NA